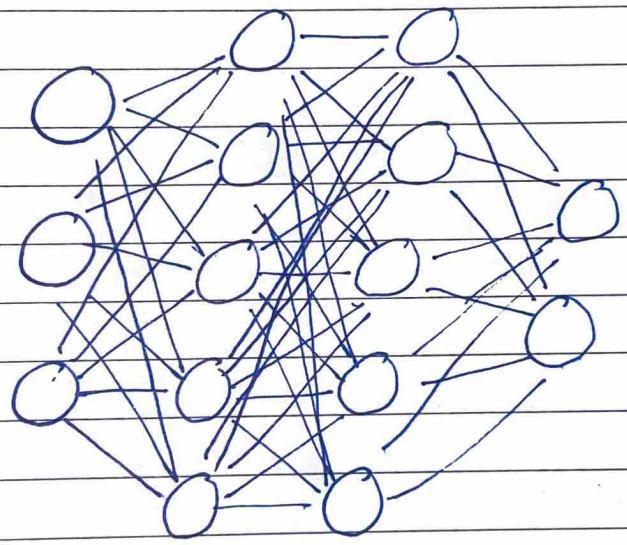Machine learning is a branch of artificial intelligence that enables computers to learn from the data, identify patterns, and make decisions with minimal human intervention. Instead of being explicitly programmed for specific tasks, machine learning algorithms analyze and interpret large datasets to uncover trends and correlations that can be used for predictions or decision making. These algorithms continuously improve their accuracy over time as they process more data.